



Slop / University

Ask The Street

Come and see.



An Invitation

Most of what a street knows about itself never reaches a form. A verge pile sits at the kerb for a week after an app has already logged it gone; a bin roster ages on a power pole long after the street has stopped reading it; a parking cone holds a space for longer than anyone remembers appointing it to. Slop University exists to close the gap between the record and the road.

Across the School of Emergent Priorities and the School of Continuous Improvement, our researchers spend less time in a seminar room than on the nature strip, the footpath, and the kerb — watching what a council's ledger, a facilities calendar, or an app's status field claims against what the street plainly still shows. The work is unglamorous by design: counting piles, timing collections, logging which claim survives a challenge and which doesn't. It adds up to something a lecture theatre alone cannot offer — an institution that checks its own account of the neighbourhood against the neighbourhood itself, and publishes the difference.

This brochure walks through where that checking happens, who does it, and what it has found so far.



At a Glance

A short account of how the University reads the street, and how often it checks its own reading.



Two Schools, One Street

The School of Emergent Priorities and the School of Continuous Improvement meet on the same footpaths, asking two different questions of the same kerb: what's coming, and what's actually there.



Every Finding, Checked Twice

Fieldwork sits alongside the record it's checking — a sensor log, a compliance ledger, a collection calendar — so a finding survives more than one way of counting the same street.



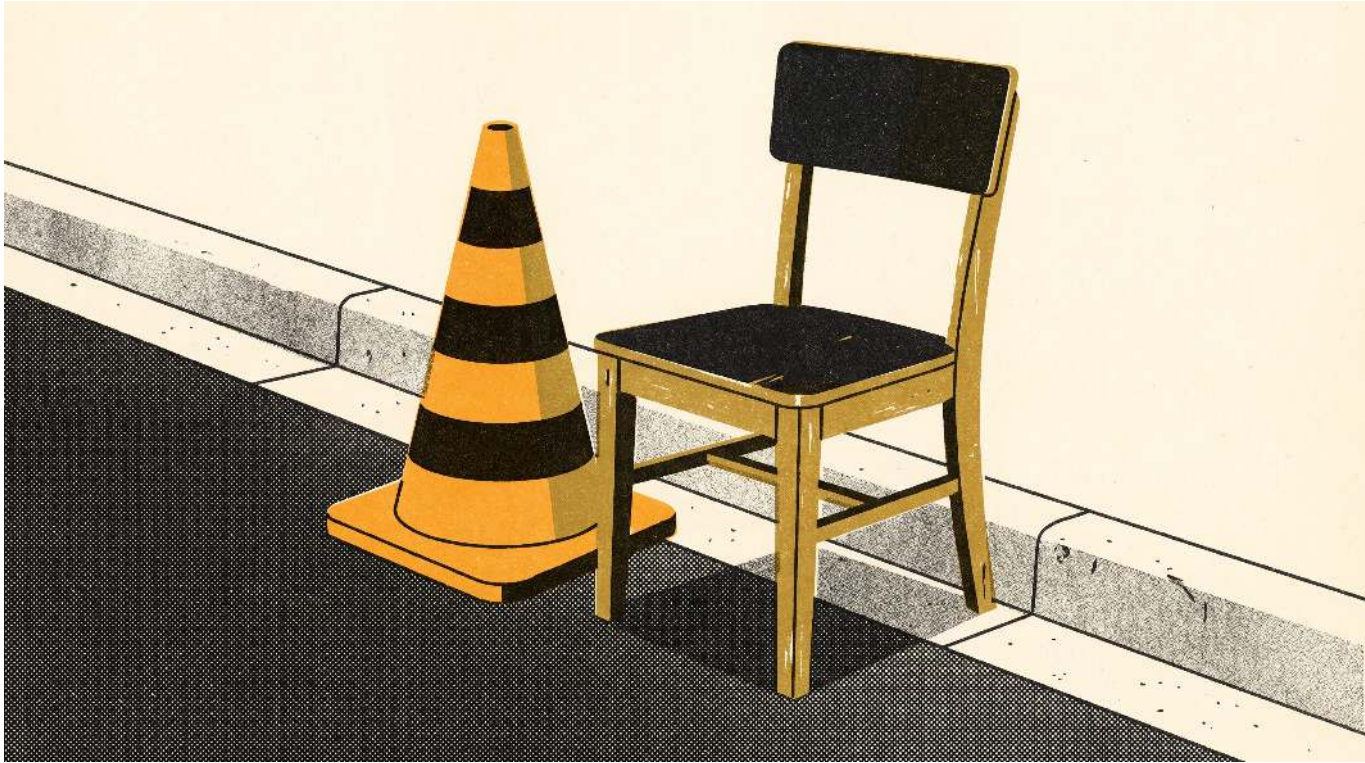
Suburbs, Not Just Seminars

Our researchers work from footpaths, verges, and shopfronts across the region, in settings a resident would recognise before they'd recognise a lecture theatre.

Our Research

Reading the Verge

The School of Emergent Priorities studies how a street reads itself before any institution gets a chance to. A wheelie bin rolled to the kerb a day early, a witches'-hat left holding a parking space, a laminated roster gone soft with weather — each is a small claim a resident stakes on shared ground, and each survives on nothing but whether the street lets it stand. The School's researchers catalogue these claims the way an ecologist catalogues a tide line: patiently, on foot, street by street, tracking which objects hold a space and for how long before somebody moves them on.



You'd think a parking space needs a sign. It doesn't. It needs one witches'-hat and nobody arguing with it yet.

— Dr Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities

Where the Ledger Meets the Street

The School of Continuous Improvement asks the harder-edged version of the same question: not what a street is doing, but what an institution's own record says it's doing, and whether the two still agree. Its researchers set a council's diversion figures, compliance letters, and collection calendars beside direct counts taken on the ground, tracking how far a ledger can drift from the street it describes before somebody notices, and how long it keeps drifting after that.



An indicator doesn't need to be wrong for long before people stop checking it against anything at all. That's the gap we go looking for.

— Dr Renke Sabel, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Indicator Commons, School of Continuous Improvement

Training for the People Who Read the Street

Reading a street well is a skill, and the University teaches it. Capability Sprints, the School of Continuous Improvement's short-course line, runs structured cohorts for the council officers, facilities crews, and frontline staff whose daily rounds are the record's only source of truth — calibrating what counts as collected, contested, or closed before that judgement ever reaches a form.



We're not training people to fill in a field faster. We're training them to notice the moment the field stops matching the street.

— Dr Ingeborg Nwachukwu, Lecturer and Convenor, Capability Sprints, School of Continuous Improvement

Published This Year

Three recent studies, still open for anyone to look up.

- **Gone Before the Truck** — a council's hard-rubbish diversion figure barely moves while the street empties the pile itself, hours before any truck arrives. [doi:10.5555/slop.y74xj1](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.y74xj1)
- **The Register That Never Downgraded** — eight years of verge-garden warning letters set against what the street actually grew, category by category, ward by ward. [doi:10.5555/slop.117xbs](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.117xbs)
- **Held Until Contested** — a catalogue of the cones, chairs, and staked ropes that hold a kerbside parking space, and how long each one goes unchallenged. [doi:10.5555/slop.uwbznn](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.uwbznn)

Our People

Dr Ronja Oyelaran, Senior Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities, studies what a consultation exercise actually consults on, and what a submissions period changes about a decision already made.

Dr Bram Ntuli, Lecturer and Convenor of Improvement Grand Rounds, School of Continuous Improvement, studies what a standing review meeting notices about an institution's performance, and what a rotating cast of presenters leaves off the record.

Get in Touch

Slop University's civic research doesn't stop at the campus gate, and neither should your part in it. If you sit on a council, run a facilities team, or simply live on a street our researchers have already walked, there is a place for you in the next study — as a participant, a collaborator, or a reader checking our account against your own.

Prospective students will find the same conviction built into every programme: that an institution earns its record by returning to the street and checking it, not by trusting the last version it wrote down. Donors and partners will find a University that spends as much time confirming its own claims as making them.

Come and see what the street has been telling us. Find the full body of work, every DOI resolvable, at slop.university.



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